

Romanticism

Alongside Neoclassicism, an artistic, literary and intellectual movement developed that focused on the emotions. Emerging partly as a reaction against the cool reason and moral purpose of Neoclassicism, and partly in accord with it, Romanticism was interpreted differently by artists, writers and composers, developing as a diverse movement across Europe from the late 18th to the late 19th century. Like Neoclassicism, it reflected elements of the revolutionary spirit, but contrastingly, it displayed passions with painterly brushwork and vivid colours, or imaginatively composed statues.

Romantic artists favoured colour over line and moved away from idealized representations of the classical past in favour of imagination, intuition, and more individual and varied ideas. Eugène Delacroix and Théodore Géricault pioneered the movement in France, while Francisco de Goya produced powerful evocations of events in Spain, and Britain's William Blake (1757–1827) created visionary and symbolic images and poems.



Delacroix, *The Death of Sardanapalus*, 1827